

UNIT 4 / Build your sentences

Ask better questions

Your goal: Form yes/no questions and questions with question words.

01 Learn the idea

For a yes/no question, put the conjugated verb first: Wohnst du hier? Answer Ja or Nein and add a short sentence. For a question with a question word, use question word + verb + subject: Wo wohnst du? The verb remains near the start even when the question is longer.

Wer asks who, was asks what, wo asks where, woher asks where from and wann asks when. Wie asks how and appears in fixed questions such as Wie heißt du? Choose the question word based on the information you want. Compare Wo wohnst du? with Wann lernst du? rather than memorising word order alone.

Words and phrases

German	English
Wer ist das?	Who is that?
Was machst du?	What are you doing?
Wann lernst du?	When do you study?
Wohnst du hier?	Do you live here?
Wo ist das Café?	Where is the café?

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Mia

Wohnst du in Berlin?

Do you live in Berlin?

Ben

Ja. Und wo wohnst du?

Yes. And where do you live?

Mia

In Köln. Wann lernst du Deutsch?

In Cologne. When do you study German?

Ben

Am Abend.

In the evening.

Your real-life mission

Write three yes/no questions and three question-word questions for a new classmate. Give a short answer to each.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Wer ist das?” mean?

- A. What are you doing?
- B. Who is that?
- C. When do you study?

2. What does “Was machst du?” mean?

- A. When do you study?
- B. Do you live here?
- C. What are you doing?

3. What does “Wann lernst du?” mean?

- A. When do you study?
- B. Do you live here?
- C. Where is the café?

4. Which word order makes a yes/no question?

- A. Du wohnst hier?
- B. Wohnst du hier?
- C. Hier du wohnst?

5. When does Ben study German?

- A. In the morning
- B. At noon
- C. In the evening

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. B - Who is that?

“Wer ist das?” means “Who is that?”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. C - What are you doing?

“Was machst du?” means “What are you doing?”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. A - When do you study?

“Wann lernst du?” means “When do you study?”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - Wohnst du hier?

The standard neutral yes/no question begins with the conjugated verb.

5. C - In the evening

Ben answers Am Abend.

One possible mission response

Lernst du Deutsch? Ja. Wo wohnst du? In Berlin. Wann lernst du? Am Abend.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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